

Utkarsh Gupta and the Business of India's Wasted Potential



Utkarsh Gupta
Founder, Gruner Renewable Energy

India's clean energy transition is often framed through large targets and global commitments, but Utkarsh Gupta's vision begins in India's farmlands, where agricultural residue is still too often treated as waste. For decades, paddy stubble and crop residue have contributed to pollution, soil damage and North India's recurring air-quality crisis. Utkarsh saw the same problem differently: not as discarded biomass, but as a powerful energy resource that provides clean fuel, farmer income, and the foundation for a scalable green enterprise.

That thinking has shaped Gruner Renewable Energy, founded by Utkarsh in 2023 and built within three years into a ₹4,500 crore green energy enterprise. At a time when many companies in the renewable sector are still searching for profitable scale, Gruner has remained EBITDA-positive since inception. With a team of over 1,000 professionals and operations extending across India and Europe, the company has grown rapidly without losing sight of its central idea:

India's energy future must be built from the ground up.

Gruner is not a conventional renewable energy company built around one product or one market. It is an integrated platform working across bioenergy infrastructure, agri-tech, indigenous manufacturing, artificial intelligence and global technology partnerships. Its strength lies in connecting these pieces into a single operating model. The company is building clean energy infrastructure, but it is also building the rural and industrial systems required to make that infrastructure viable.

With experts such as Mehmet Önal, who brings experience in building over 500 biogas plants over 25 years across Europe, the company gives Gruner access to global bioenergy expertise, advanced plant design knowledge, engineering precision, and European execution standards. This enables Gruner to combine India's large-scale clean energy opportunity with proven international biogas experience.

Kisani Urjaa, Gruner's agri-energy platform, is converting crop residue into a structured clean energy supply chain, connecting 30,000+ farmers and collecting 20,000+ MT of biomass while creating rural income and reducing stubble burning. Its Kisani Didi model, coined by Utkarsh, has brought 500+ rural women into formal roles as farmer coordinators and local entrepreneurs. This grassroots network is complemented by Gruner New Inergie Deutschland, a European company established by Utkarsh to strengthen Gruner's technology and engineering capabilities.

This is what makes the company's story different. Gruner's sustainability model is not limited to carbon reduction. It is also about creating rural livelihoods, formalising informal work, and giving communities a direct role in India's green economy.

On the industrial side, Gruner is pursuing the same principle of self-reliance through Astute Synergies. India's renewable energy sector still depends heavily on imported equipment, especially for specialised biogas components and precision engineering. Astute Synergies has been created to address this gap by building domestic manufacturing capability supported by global technology partnerships and knowledge transfer. The objective is clear: India's clean energy transition should not remain dependent on imported hardware. It must be manufactured, assembled and scaled within the country while maintaining European standards.

Utkarsh's broader vision is to combine European engineering discipline with Indian executional speed. He does not see global collaboration and Indian self-reliance as opposing ideas. For Gruner, the future lies in bringing the two together: adopting international technology standards while building local manufacturing depth, rural networks and cost-efficient execution.

That is the enterprise Utkarsh Gupta is building: not merely a renewable energy company, but a green economy system.

As India moves towards its 2070 net-zero goal, the companies that will define the transition will not be the ones chasing scale alone. They will be the ones solving the harder, less glamorous problems feedstock, logistics, manufacturing, rural participation and execution. In three years, Utkarsh has placed Gruner Renewable Energy at the centre of that opportunity: global in ambition, Indian in execution, and rooted in the value of what the country once threw away.